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Please write clearly in block capitals.

Centre number | | | | | |

Candidate number | | | | |

Surname

Forename(s)

Candidate signature

English Language

Paper 1 Section A: Explorations in creative reading

Suggested time: about 50 minutes. There is no timer.

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- a black pen
- Source A, printed on the next page

Instructions

- Answer all questions.
- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- You must refer to the source in your answers.
- Read the source and all four questions before you start.

Information

- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- The maximum mark for this paper is 40.
- This practice paper covers Section A only. The real Paper 1 also has Section B (writing, 40 marks).

For Examiner's Use	
Question	**Mark**
1	
2	
3	
4	
TOTAL	

This is a practice paper written for Dougie in the style of the GCSE exam. The source was written for this paper. It is not an exam board paper, and it is not a paper from any past exam series.

Source A

This extract is from the opening of a short story written for this practice paper. Nell is waiting on the harbour wall for the evening ferry, which is bringing her brother home.

By four o'clock the town had given up on the day. The shops along the front pulled down their shutters one by one, and the fish and chip shop turned its sign to Closed. Gulls sat hunched on the railings with their backs to the wind. Only the lifeboat station still had its lights on, a square of yellow at the end of the grey promenade.

Out past the harbour, the sea had been changing colour all afternoon. At lunchtime it had been the soft green of old glass. Now it was the colour of a bruise, and it was moving in a way Nell did not like.

The storm came in from the west like a closing door. First the light went, drained out of the sky as if someone had pulled a plug. Then the rain arrived, not falling but thrown, flung sideways in fistfuls that rattled against the harbour wall. The waves stood up, grey and heavy, and threw themselves at the stones again and again, as though they had a grudge to settle. Spray burst over the wall in great white sheets.

The wind screamed through the masts of the moored boats, and every rope and chain in the harbour began to clang and shriek.

Nell pulled her hood tighter and stayed where she was.

She had been standing on the harbour wall for an hour. Her fingers had stopped hurting a while ago, which she knew was a bad sign, and her trainers were so wet that her socks squelched when she shifted her weight. Mum had told her to wait inside the café. Mum had told her a lot of things.

The ferry was due at half past four. Kieran would be on it, with his big rucksack and his stupid grin, back from six months working on the rigs. He had promised he would be home before her birthday, and her birthday was tomorrow.

She thought about the last time she had seen him, on this same wall, in August. It had been so hot that the tar between the stones had gone soft. He had bought her an ice cream, then eaten half of it himself, and when she complained he had laughed and lifted her right off her feet. "Six months, Nellie," he had said. "You won't even notice."

She had noticed. She had noticed every single day.

Twenty to five. Then quarter to. The harbour master came out of his hut in a yellow coat and stood at the end of the wall, staring at the sea. He did not wave to her, the way he usually did. He just stared.

Nell watched him lift a radio to his mouth and say something she could not hear.

Behind her, the doors of the lifeboat station rolled open. Men in orange were running, pulling on helmets as they ran.

Her heart was hammering now, so loud she could feel it in her ears. She told herself that boats were late all the time. She told herself that ferries were built for weather like this. She told herself a lot of things.

And then, far out in the dark, so small that at first she thought she had imagined it, a light appeared. It rose, and fell, and rose again.

Nell held her breath, and did not dare to blink.

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Section A: Reading

Answer all questions in this section. You are advised to spend about 45 minutes on this section, after about 5 minutes reading the source and the questions.

0 1 Read again the first part of the source, from lines 1 to 5. List four things about the town from this part of the source.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

4 _____

[4 marks]

0 2 Look in detail at this extract, from lines 9 to 16 of the source. How does the writer use language here to describe the storm?
You could include the writer's choice of: words and phrases; language features and techniques; sentence forms.

> The storm came in from the west like a closing door. First the light went, drained out of the sky as if someone had pulled a plug. Then the rain arrived, not falling but thrown, flung sideways in fistfuls that rattled against the harbour wall. The waves stood up, grey and heavy, and threw themselves at the stones again and again, as though they had a grudge to settle. Spray burst over the wall in great white sheets.
> The wind screamed through the masts of the moored boats, and every rope and chain in the harbour began to clang and shriek.

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[8 marks]

0 3 You now need to think about the whole of the source. This text is from the opening of a short story. How has the writer structured the text to interest you as a reader? You could write about: what the writer focuses your attention on at the beginning; how and why the writer changes this focus as the source develops; any other structural features that interest you.

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[8 marks]

0 4 Focus this part of your answer on the second part of the source, from line 33 to the end. A student said: "In this part of the story, the writer makes us feel Nell's fear really strongly, but also gives us a bit of hope. It's as if we're waiting on the wall with her." To what extent do you agree?
In your response, you could: consider your own impressions of Nell's feelings; evaluate how the writer has created these impressions; support your response with references to the text.

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[20 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS